Russia's unique role as a counterbalance in global affairs and the development of a worldwide civilization (Russian Foreign Policy Concept 2013).[13] Russia maintained a balancing approach with the Western and Southern world countries. However, Putin's bias toward the southern world nations was reflected in his foreign policy concepts and security concepts resulting from SCO, BRICS, etc. Russia's relationship with BRICS has even become a debating point within international relations since 2009 due to several of BRICS objectives and actions. Russia was the first country to give a political shape to the BRICS and promote its activities in regular intervals.

The growing instability, turbelent times and modern nation states are important actors of contemprary international relations rather than global institutions. While this changed with the rise of BRICS, how does Russia now view BRICS? What is Russia's role in the evolution of the BRICS group? What is its approach toward BRICS? How will Russia use BRICS as a platform for change? Can Russia use BRICS as a platform to counter Western hegemonic domination in international relations? The chapter further talks about it in a detailed manner.

First and foremost, Russia realizes that Russia needs to play a decisive role in BRICS to make the BRICS an influential player in present world affairs. Indeed, Russia mobilized other group members to shape BRICS as a political and economic group. Furthermore, the role of Russia in BRICS would be a deciding factor in its dominance in international politics.

Russia's Role in the Origin of BRICS

Putin was the first to propel this group as a more political group and coordinate the group for a more democratic world order in international relations (Akulov 2012). Russia was the first country to establish the BRICS group and was one of the major geopolitical events at the beginning of the twenty-first century. After that, the group managed to change prominent factors in world affairs, and the establishment of BRICS became a landmark trend in forming a polycentric system within international relations. BRICS is increasingly characterized by using non-institutionalized global governance approaches, network-based diplomacy, and enhancing the economic interdependence of states (Concept of Participation of the Russian Federation in BRICS 2013).[14] The Concept